

“Complete PC” backup, which essentially creates a disk image of your entire computer that can then be saved on a hard drive, on network storage, or burnt to DVD. The Complete PC restore can also be initiated from the Windows Vista installation disc in the event of PC failure.

Backup files are exposed as “Previous Versions” under Vista. Right-clicking on any file will show a new option under Vista labelled “Restore previous versions”—it is here that you will find older versions of that particular file which can then be easily restored. A Previous version of file can either be a backed-up file or a shadow copy of a file. A shadow copy is created by the System Restore feature of Vista, while, as we just saw, backups are taken by Backup and Restore. Shadow copies are automatically created by Windows Vista as part of the System Restore process, when it a Restore Point is created. Notable here is that the ability to create shadow copies of a file are not supported under the FAT and FAT32 file systems, thus System Restore does not extend protection to FAT and FAT32 disks.

Note

If you use Disk Cleanup to remove Restore points, you will also lose shadow copies of your files

4.5.8 Windows Mail

This is the replacement for Outlook Express under Vista. However, some features have been dropped from Windows Mail such as support for WebDAV (a protocol that allows users to collaboratively edit and manage files on remote web servers) and integration with Messenger. The program also lacks integration with Windows Calendar. Finally, Windows Mail no longer supports multiple identities within one running instance of the program. Multiple identities are used to set different properties and options under the program—say one for office use, which uses IMAP to fetch mails, and another for a roaming account, which might be a POP access. Such identities are now tied to the user account and in order to create a new identity, one needs to create a new user account under Windows Mail.